



UNSW Global
AUSTRALIA

INTRODUCTORY PAPER



2016 ICAS

International Competitions
and Assessments for Schools

ENGLISH

Educational Assessment Australia
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DO NOT OPEN THIS BOOKLET UNTIL INSTRUCTED.

35 QUESTIONS

TIME ALLOWED: 40 MINUTES

STUDENT'S NAME: Thevindu

Read the instructions on the **ANSWER SHEET** and fill in your **NAME, SCHOOL** and **OTHER INFORMATION**.

Use a 2B or B pencil.

Do **NOT** use a pen.

Rub out any mistakes completely.

You **MUST** record your answers on the **ANSWER SHEET**.

Mark only **ONE** answer for each question.

Your score will be the number of correct answers.

Marks are **NOT** deducted for incorrect answers.

There are **35 MULTIPLE-CHOICE QUESTIONS** (1–35).

Use the information provided to choose the **BEST** answer from the four possible options.

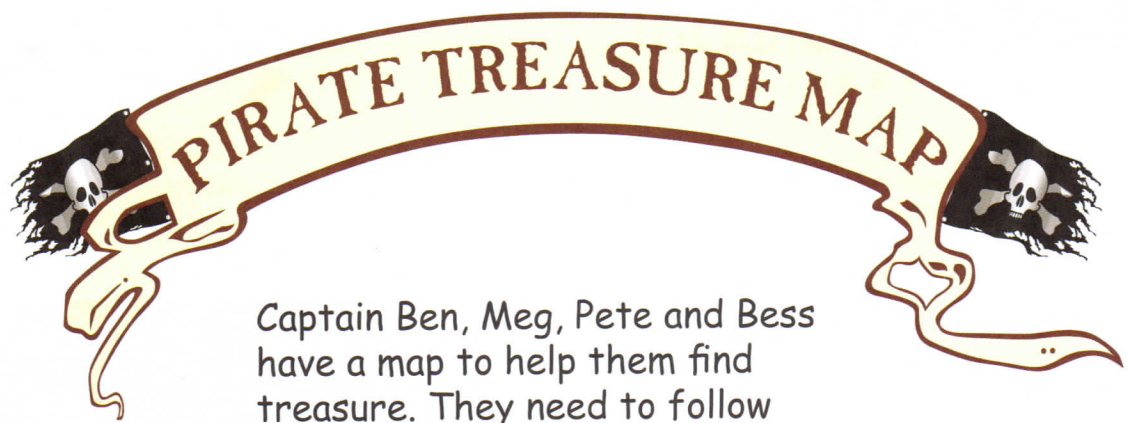
On your **ANSWER SHEET** fill in the oval that matches your answer.

Questions may sometimes be placed next to each other.

Make sure you read **ACROSS** the page and answer the questions in the correct order.

You are **NOT** allowed to use a dictionary or an electronic translator.

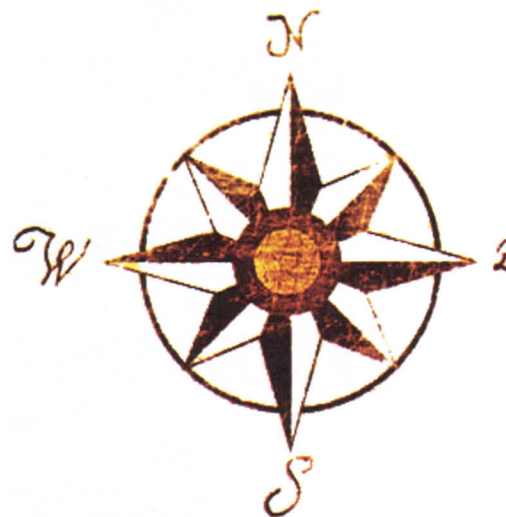
Read the text and answer the questions that follow.



Captain Ben, Meg, Pete and Bess have a map to help them find treasure. They need to follow the red line to X.



1. Who is the captain?
- (A) Ben
 - (B) Meg
 - (C) Pete
 - (D) Bess
2. The treasure map tells the pirates to start at
- (A) Skull Island.
 - (B) Shark Reef.
 - (C) Rock Run.
 - (D) Bone Beach.
3. What is the treasure closest to?
- (A) Box Cove
 - (B) Red Volcano
 - (C) Rat Hills
 - (D) Blue Lake



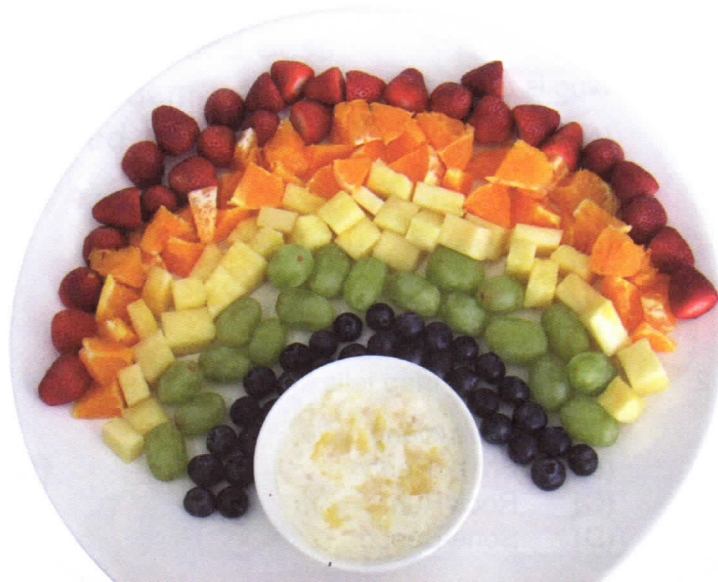
Read the text and answer the questions that follow.

How to make a fruit rainbow

This fruit rainbow is fresh and easy to make. Why not try it for your next party?

Ingredients:

24 strawberries
2 oranges
½ pineapple
1 cup green grapes
1 cup blueberries
½ cup crushed pineapple
½ cup Greek yoghurt



Step 1



Ask an adult to help you cut up the strawberries, oranges and pineapple.

Step 2



Make a rainbow shape with the fruit on a large plate. Put down the blueberries first, then the grapes, pineapple, oranges and strawberries.

Step 3



Mix the crushed pineapple with the yoghurt in a small bowl to make a dip.

Step 4



Put the bowl of dip at the centre of the fruit rainbow.

4. Which arrow points to a list of things you will need?

Read the text and answer the questions that follow.

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5. The word 'crushed' is closest in meaning to
- (A) cut.
 - (B) peeled.
 - (C) trimmed.
 - (D) squashed.
6. What piece of equipment is needed to complete Step 1?
- (A) a knife
 - (B) a fork
 - (C) a bowl
 - (D) a spoon
7. Which fruit do you put on the plate first to make the rainbow?
- (A) grapes
 - (B) strawberries
 - (C) blueberries
 - (D) oranges

For each question, choose the word that best completes the sentence.

Joke Time!

8. Why do cows _____ bells?

Because their horns don't work.

- (A) wore
- (B) wear
- (C) wears
- (D) wearing

9. Why do fish live in salt water?

Because pepper makes _____ sneeze!

- (A) it
- (B) they
- (C) them
- (D) you



Roller-coaster

We climb higher and higher and higher. Clickety-clack, clickety-clack. I use one hand to grip the bar holding me in place and the other to squeeze my sister Julie's hand. This is my first ride on a roller-coaster. The ride is pointing towards the sky. We reach the top. I think I can touch the clouds. Everyone stops talking. Everyone waits to go down the other side. Mum and Dad wave to us from the ground, looking so safe and small. They look like tiny toys. Dad shouts, 'Hold on, Damien!'

Then whoosh, zoom! Everyone is screaming. What was I thinking? My stomach does a loop-the-loop. Wind is slapping my face as we race down the first hill. I feel like I'm falling. No, I feel like I'm flying like a bird!

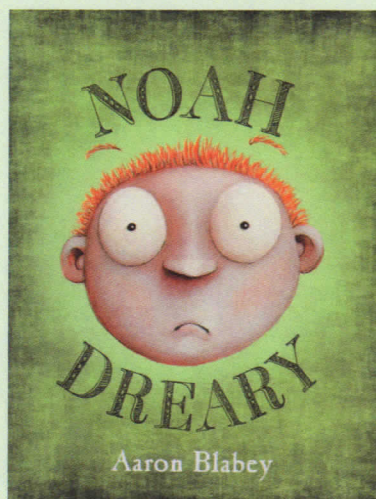
We roll up the next hill, the wheels squealing on the metal track. Julie looks at me, her eyes wide and shining. I start to giggle, then we whoosh down the hill. We twist and turn as the ride hurries around the tight corners. Julie and I bump into each other as we lean this way and that. Then we jolt to a stop. I can't believe the ride is over so soon. My head is wobbly, my knees are shaky, but my smile is huge.

'Do you want to go again, Julie?' I say, nudging her with my elbow.



10. Why does everyone stop talking?
- (A) They can't hear each other over the noise of the roller-coaster.
 - (B) They know the roller-coaster is about to go down the first hill.
 - (C) They are too busy waving to their families from the roller-coaster.
 - (D) They don't understand why the roller-coaster is not moving.
11. Which of the following sentences compares one thing to another?
- (A) 'We climb higher and higher and higher.'
 - (B) 'The ride is pointing towards the sky.'
 - (C) 'They look like tiny toys.'
 - (D) 'Everyone is screaming.'
12. 'We roll up the next hill, the wheels squealing on the metal track.'
- Which underlined word from the sentence describes an action?
- (A) 'next'
 - (B) 'wheels'
 - (C) 'squealing'
 - (D) 'track'
13. Which option shows when Damien no longer felt scared being on the roller-coaster?
- (A) 'I think I can touch the clouds.'
 - (B) 'No, I feel like I'm flying like a bird!'
 - (C) 'I start to giggle'
 - (D) 'my knees are shaky, but my smile is huge'
14. Which of these describes a sound in the text?
- (A) 'whoosh'
 - (B) 'loop-the-loop'
 - (C) 'twist and turn'
 - (D) 'wobbly'
15. When Damien nudges Julie, it is a sign that he is
- (A) bossy.
 - (B) grateful.
 - (C) annoyed.
 - (D) excited.

Book Reviews



Noah Dreary

Aaron Blabey

'One day, Noah Dreary complained so much that his head fell off.'

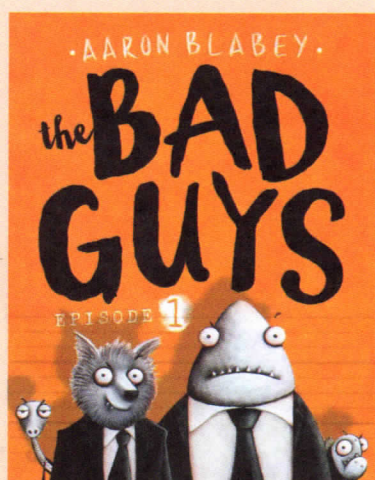
With a great opening line like this, how could you resist turning to the next page?

It seems that nothing pleases Noah Dreary. He complains about everything, from one tiny cloud in the sky to the lack of added sugar in his breakfast cereal. No wonder his head falls off and bounces on the living room rug! His mum rushes him to hospital, but nothing can be done. This makes Noah complain even more. Then one fateful day the wind blows his head down a grassy hill and into the ocean. This changes everything.

You'll be pleased to know that there is a happy ending. It's such a laugh-out-loud book with hilarious, oversize illustrations. But there's a hint of a moral: Noah learns to make the most of what he has and be happy.



Viking



The Bad Guys: Episode 1

Aaron Blabey

Everyone knows that wolves, sharks, snakes and piranhas are bad, right? You only have to look at all those teeth to know that. When these four creatures form a gang, we can expect mayhem. Who knows what terrible things they'll get up to? But not the four creatures in this book. Mr Wolf has decided he wants to be a good guy and he convinces the others to give it a go. Breaking the stereotype is not as easy as you would think. It's probably something to do with all those teeth. However, the guys persevere and in the end ... well, you'll see.

Although this story is suitable for younger readers, its appeal isn't limited to just the 8-year-old age group. It's always good to see bullies make the effort to change their behaviour. It's a lighthearted, humorous look at an important issue. Hopefully, while readers are laughing at the artwork and the funny dialogue, they'll also be learning a really important lesson without realising it.



Scholastic



16. Which event leads to Noah's new attitude?
- (A) his head bouncing on the living room rug
 - (B) his head being blown into the ocean
 - (C) his mum taking him to hospital
 - (D) his mum adding more sugar to his breakfast



17. What is the purpose of the question in the first sentence of *The Bad Guys* review?
- (A) to interest readers in finding out how some animals live
 - (B) to help readers appreciate the differences between characters
 - (C) to hint to readers that the story will unfold in an unusual way
 - (D) to encourage readers to think about why they fear certain animals



18. The words 'we can expect mayhem' mean that readers can expect the characters will
- (A) be funny.
 - (B) be surprising.
 - (C) cause trouble.
 - (D) become angry.



19. In *The Bad Guys* review, which word could replace 'Although' at the beginning of the second paragraph?
- (A) While
 - (B) Because
 - (C) However
 - (D) Since



20. Based on the review, the book *The Bad Guys* is mainly about four creatures who
- (A) work together to help humans.
 - (B) go on an adventure together.
 - (C) attempt to improve themselves.
 - (D) learn to make the most of what they have.



21. Based on information in the reviews, why does Aaron Blabey use humour in both *Noah Dreary* and *The Bad Guys*?
- (A) to make it easier to discuss bad behaviour
 - (B) to make everyday situations more exciting
 - (C) to encourage readers to like the characters
 - (D) to encourage readers to accept their own weaknesses



22. A comparison of these two reviews shows that they both
- (A) describe all the characters in detail.
 - (B) give brief information about the storyline.
 - (C) describe the strengths and weaknesses of the book.
 - (D) provide the target age group for the book.

Read the text and answer the questions that follow.

This text is from Book written by John Agard.

No Children or Dogs Allowed



Did you know that even though there were libraries in ancient Rome, it wasn't until the middle of the 1800s that libraries were opened to the general public for free? Before then they belonged to royal households, monasteries, cathedrals and universities.

Nowadays, all you need is that magical thing called a library card, and a library is no longer a hush-hush place for the wealthy.

Sitting on my shelf, I listen in to storytellers telling stories, and novelists and poets reading aloud from their work and saying what inspired them. I see illustrators doing drawings right there in front of wide-eyed schoolchildren on cushions. I even hear the children joining in and clapping, till I feel like clapping my own pages.

But I can remember the days when there were signs outside libraries:

NO CHILDREN OR DOGS ALLOWED.

How times change.

Now libraries are for everyone, and what really makes my day is when I give pleasure to the elderly who come to have a read or just to keep warm and enjoy a bit of company. Those ancient Greeks knew what they were talking about when they called a library the 'medicine chest of the soul'.

It's a bit different today, of course, because I can see stacks of DVDs and computer screens staring at me from my shelf. Sometimes I feel like saying, 'What are you looking at?' But I mustn't be rude, even though I'm a little disappointed when someone puts me back on the shelf and decides to borrow a DVD instead.

Never mind. I, Book, know how to be patient. One day a hand will reach for me and take me to the counter to be stamped, checked out and, we hope, returned.

When politicians talk about closing a library to save money, I feel like knocking them over the head. And my hardback spine can give a jolly hard knock, I can tell you.

Ah, libraries. Where would I be without them? Having said that, where would they be without me? They are my orchard; I am their fruit.

23. What type of information is given in the first paragraph?
- (A) a discussion about libraries in the community
 - (B) historical facts about libraries
 - (C) the writer's opinion about the role of libraries in education
 - (D) an argument about the cost of libraries
24. Which word could replace 'hush-hush' in the text?
- (A) restricted
 - (B) beautiful
 - (C) fashionable
 - (D) relaxing
25. The ancient Greeks called libraries the 'medicine chest of the soul' because they believed that libraries
- (A) strengthened people's physical health.
 - (B) provided information about common diseases.
 - (C) offered shelter from bad weather.
 - (D) improved people's wellbeing.
26. What is Book's attitude towards the DVDs in the library?
- (A) curious
 - (B) confused
 - (C) irritated
 - (D) amused
27. The last paragraph expresses the idea that
- (A) books would be better off without libraries.
 - (B) libraries and books go together.
 - (C) books and libraries compete against each other.
 - (D) people should be grateful to have libraries and books.
28. What is most surprising about the text?
- (A) why it was written
 - (B) when it was written
 - (C) where it is set
 - (D) who is telling the story
29. What is the text mostly about?
- (A) why you should belong to a library
 - (B) why libraries were opened to the public
 - (C) how libraries have changed over time
 - (D) when the first free libraries were opened

Public aquariums: underwater zoos

Public aquariums are essentially zoos for fish and other creatures that live underwater. Aquariums have to be strong to hold so much water and sea life. The first public aquariums were made from glass, but glass is relatively heavy and easy to break. The clear plastic acrylic (uh-KRIL-ik) used to make most modern public aquariums is stronger than glass. Acrylic can also be made more easily into shapes such as tunnels.

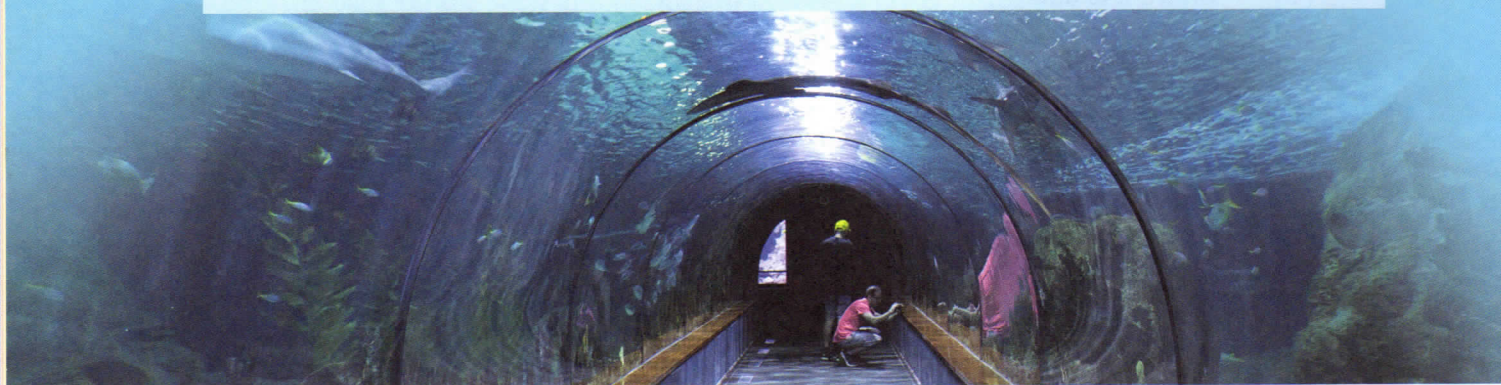
Just as zookeepers create a cosy home for their animals, the people who look after aquariums have to make sure the sea creatures they care for are happy and comfortable. It can be difficult to get the tank conditions just right. As well as providing places like rock caves, corals, logs and seaweed for sea creatures to play and hide in, there are many things that need to be checked. These include water temperature, water chemistry (the chemicals that are in the water), water movement and lighting.

One of the most important elements in providing a good home for sea life is water quality. This is about more than just keeping water clear and easy for visitors to look through; animals in aquariums need clean water with just the right balance of chemicals to stay healthy.

Reef HQ Aquarium, in Townsville, Australia, is the largest coral reef aquarium in the world. The water quality is maintained in a number of different ways. To start with, water is pumped through filters which remove big particles and make the water cleaner. The water is then pumped through protein skimmers. These are tubes filled with tiny gas bubbles. Tiny pieces of fish poo and algae in the water stick to the bubbles. These bubbles float to the top of the skimmers and are then scooped away, taking the small particles with them.

Reef HQ's water quality can also be affected by heavy rains which dilute the water in the tanks. If the salinity level (or saltiness) of the water changes suddenly, fish and corals may die. Reef HQ uses machines which can remove the excess fresh water from the coral reef tank.

Some aquariums are built under the sea. Kelly Tarlton's Underwater World in Auckland, New Zealand, was the first aquarium in the world to include a see-through tunnel beneath the sea. The tunnel now has a moving floor, so visitors feel like they are walking underwater right alongside the fish. This tunnel has become a model for other aquariums around the world.



- 
30. What is the main purpose of the second paragraph?
- (A) to identify factors which affect tank conditions
 - (B) to discuss the importance of water quality
 - (C) to praise the work of aquarium staff
 - (D) to provide a checklist of cleaning processes
31. What happens during the second stage of the water quality process at Reef HQ?
- (A) Large particles are trapped by skimmers and forced through filters at the top of the tank.
 - (B) The water is pumped through skimmers and bubbles carry the small particles to the water surface.
 - (C) Fish poo and algae are converted into gas bubbles that are collected at the top of the skimmers.
 - (D) Clean water is pumped through tubes to create gas bubbles which collect small particles in the water.
32. After heavy rains, why does Reef HQ remove fresh water from the tanks?
- (A) to maintain the correct level of saltiness
 - (B) to make the water cleaner
 - (C) to keep the water temperature the same
 - (D) to decrease the amount of algae
33. What does the word 'model' mean, as it is used in the text?
- (A) an older type
 - (B) an exact copy
 - (C) a smaller version
 - (D) a good example
34. Which of the following factors would **NOT** directly affect the water conditions in a public aquarium?
- (A) the number of visitors to a public aquarium
 - (B) the number of creatures in a public aquarium
 - (C) the size of a tank in a public aquarium
 - (D) the type of creatures in a public aquarium
35. What is the main idea of the text?
- (A) how cleaning processes affect water chemistry in public aquariums
 - (B) how the use of acrylic is essential to modern aquariums
 - (C) how water salinity in public aquariums affects sea creatures
 - (D) how the environment for sea creatures in public aquariums is maintained
- 